Fancy

# Bass Chords

and Their Voicings

**(B) E A D G**

https://fancychords.com

## Movable Shapes

Bass  closed, so they move

| shape | root on | bottom | example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **fifths** | | | |
| 02xx | E | R | 13xx = F5 |
| x02x | A | R | x13x = Bb5 |
| xx02 | D | R | xx13 = Eb5 |
| 3x0x | E | R | 4x1x = Ab5 |
| **major** | | | |
| 02x1 | E | R | 13x2 = F |
| 320x | E | R | 431x = Ab |
| x320 | A | R | x431 = Db |
| **minor** | | | |
| 02x0 | E | R | 13x1 = Fm |
| 310x | E | R | 421x = Abm |
| x310 | A | R | x421 = Dbm |

Shape is the fingering above its lowest fret. Slide it one fret, the chord rises a semitone. Bottom is the degree on the lowest string.

## Root Positions

Bass

| | (B) | E | A | D | G |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| C | 1 | 8 | 3 | 10 | 5 |
| Db | 2 | 9 | 4 | 11 | 6 |
| D | 3 | 10 | 5 | 0 | 7 |
| Eb | 4 | 11 | 6 | 1 | 8 |
| E | 5 | 0 | 7 | 2 | 9 |
| F | 6 | 1 | 8 | 3 | 10 |
| Gb | 7 | 2 | 9 | 4 | 11 |
| G | 8 | 3 | 10 | 5 | 0 |
| Ab | 9 | 4 | 11 | 6 | 1 |
| A | 10 | 5 | 0 | 7 | 2 |
| Bb | 11 | 6 | 1 | 8 | 3 |
| B | 0 | 7 | 2 | 9 | 4 |

Fret for the root of each key on each string. Everything else is measured from there.

## Patterns

Bass  counted from the root

**Root + fifth + octave** The default. Works under anything in the key.

| degree | R | 5 | 8 |
|---|---|---|---|
| string | R | 1+R | 2+R |
| fret | R0 | R2 | R2 |

**Major arpeggio** Major, maj7, 6.

| degree | R | 5 | 8 | 3 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| string | R | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret | R0 | R2 | R2 | R1 |

**Minor arpeggio** Minor, m7, m6.

| degree | R | 5 | 8 | b3 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| string | R | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret | R0 | R2 | R2 | R0 |

**Dominant seventh** Any 7 chord. The b7 pulls to the four.

| degree | R | 5 | b7 | 3 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| string | R | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret | R0 | R2 | R0 | R1 |

**Minor seventh** The two and the six chord.

| degree | R | 5 | b7 | b3 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| string | R | 1+R | 2+R | 3+R |
| fret | R0 | R2 | R0 | R0 |

**Walking approach** Leading into the next chord.

| degree | R | 5 | 6 | b7 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| string | R | 1+R | 1+R | 2+R |
| fret | R0 | R2 | R4 | R0 |

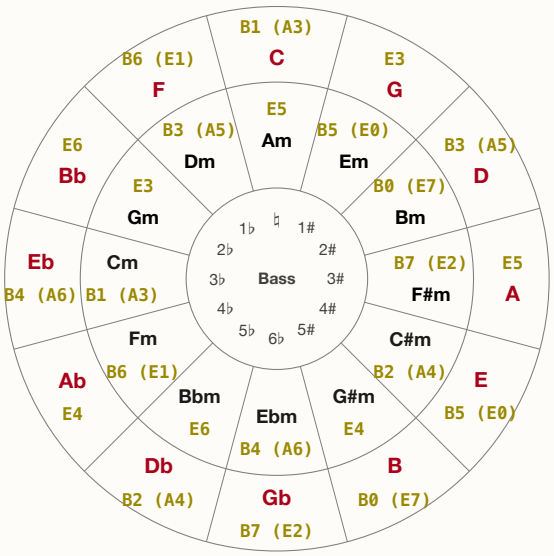
## Numbers

Bass the major scale, degree by degree

| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| C | C | D | E | F | G | A | B |
| Db | Db | Eb | F | Gb | Ab | Bb | C |
| D | D | E | F# | G | A | B | C# |
| Eb | Eb | F | G | Ab | Bb | C | D |
| E | E | F# | G# | A | B | C# | D# |
| F | F | G | A | Bb | C | D | E |
| Gb | Gb | Ab | Bb | Cb | Db | Eb | F |
| G | G | A | B | C | D | E | F# |
| Ab | Ab | Bb | C | Db | Eb | F | G |
| A | A | B | C# | D | E | F# | G# |
| Bb | Bb | C | D | Eb | F | G | A |
| B | B | C# | D# | E | F# | G# | A# |

Read across: in the key on the left, the four is the note under the 4. A minor key borrows the same row, starting from its six.

## Bass Circle of Fifths




String and fret for each root: `A3` is the third fret of the A string.
Lowest that falls under the hand.
Five-string first, four-string in parentheses.

## Tunings

**Bass** `(B) E A D G`
The guitar's lowest four strings, an octave down.

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Downloads and a printable copy:
https://fancychords.com

Source and corrections:
http://github.com/linenoise/voicings


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## What to Play Under

Bass degrees from the root

| | |
|---|---|
| major | R 3 5 |
| m | R b3 5 |
| 5 | R 5 |
| + | R 3 #5 |
| ° | R b3 b5 |
| sus2 | R 2 5 |
| sus4 | R 4 5 |
| 6 | R 3 5 6 |
| m6 | R b3 5 6 |
| 6/9 | R 9 3 5 6 |
| 7 | R 3 5 b7 |
| maj7 | R 3 5 7 |
| m7 | R b3 5 b7 |
| °7 | R b3 b5 6 |
| m7b5 | R b3 b5 b7 |
| 7sus4 | R 4 5 b7 |
| 7b5 | R 3 b5 b7 |
| 7#5 | R 3 #5 b7 |
| 9 | R 9 3 5 b7 |
| maj9 | R 9 3 5 7 |
| m9 | R 9 b3 5 b7 |
| add9 | R 9 3 5 |
| madd9 | R 9 b3 5 |
| 7b9 | R b9 3 5 b7 |
| 7#9 | R b3 3 5 b7 |
| m11 | R 9 b3 4 5 b7 |

Play the root, and the fifth if there is one.
Add the tone that names the chord, the `b3` or the `b7`, only when it wants hearing.
The rest belongs to whoever is playing chords.